

**Subject Description Form**

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| Subject Code                                 | SFT6000R                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Subject Title                                | Academic Proposal Writing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Credit Value                                 | 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Level                                        | 6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Pre-requisite/<br>Co-requisite/<br>Exclusion | Nil                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Objectives                                   | This taught subject is designed to provide research postgraduate students an opportunity to learn the basic principles and techniques in academic proposal writing. It aims to provide students with a clear understanding of the concepts, processes, and other related elements in developing a rigorous and convincing academic research proposal, such as in doctoral research.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Intended Learning Outcomes                   | <p>Upon completion of this course, students should be able to:</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>describe the key principles and processes in research proposal development</li> <li>comprehend the rigor and structures of research proposal development</li> <li>conduct the reviews and revisions of research proposal writing process</li> <li>critically review and analyse the quality of a research proposal</li> <li>apply basic scientific language (English) in proposal writing</li> </ol>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Subject Synopsis/<br>Indicative Syllabus     | <p>This subject aims to provide students with a clear understanding of the concepts, structures, processes, and language in developing an academic research proposal. The teaching contents are as following.</p> <p>Introduction to proposal writing</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Types of proposal</li> <li>Proposal development path</li> <li>Resource outreach, collaborator(s) and planning</li> </ul> <p>Proposal writing and planning</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Establishing research statement, designing the study, and proposal merit</li> <li>Developing Literature/Contextual Review</li> <li>Implication and impacts</li> <li>Scope and Limitations</li> <li>Project milestone and timeline</li> <li>Figures and tables</li> <li>Scientific language, jargon, and target audiences</li> </ul> <p>Proposal review</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Process, lead time, and revisions</li> </ul> |
| Teaching/Learning Methodology                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Lectures will deliver learning material through lectures and in-class discussion formats.</li> <li>Lecture and peer evaluation will be used to encourage interactive learning, exercise critical thinking, and assess student's learning outcomes.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

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| Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Specific assessment methods/tasks                                                                                                                                                                                                | % weighting | Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate) |   |   |   |   |          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |             | a                                                                              | b | c | d | e |          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 1. In-class participation                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 20%         | ✓                                                                              | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 2. Writing critique assignment                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 20%         | ✓                                                                              | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 3. Research proposal development                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 60%         | ✓                                                                              | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Total                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 100 %       |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes:                                                                                                                        |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Continuous assessment: Pre-class activities, class attendance & in-class participation will be assessed.                                                                                                                         |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Proposal writing critique: Students must read assigned research proposals and develop critique and discussion.                                                                                                                   |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Research proposal development: Students must develop and design a research study, based on their discipline. This will help exercise student’s ability in designing quality and rigorous research based on taught methodologies. |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |          |
| The materials submitted for this assessment must be the student’s own work. The submitted work may not be accepted for the purpose of assessment if its authenticity is questionable. Submitting GenAI-generated materials as students’ own work or part of their work is an act of academic dishonesty. Students who are found committing academic dishonesty will face disciplinary actions. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |          |
| Student Study Effort Expected                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Class contact:                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | ▪ Lectures:                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   | 12 Hrs.  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | ▪ Seminars/Presentations                                                                                                                                                                                                         |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   | 24 Hrs.  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Other student study effort:                                                                                                                                                                                                      |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   |          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | ▪ Reading, assignments, and research                                                                                                                                                                                             |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   | 69 Hrs.  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Total student study effort                                                                                                                                                                                                       |             |                                                                                |   |   |   |   | 105 Hrs. |

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| <p>Reading List and References</p> | <p><b>Publications and resources</b></p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Licklider, M. M. <i>Grant seeking in higher education: Strategies and tools for college faculty</i>. UD: John Wiley &amp; Sons, Inc., 2012.</li> <li>2. Locke, L.F, Spirduso, W.W., Silverman, S.J. <i>Proposals that work: a guide for planning dissertations and grant proposals</i>. Thousand Oaks, California: SAGE, 2014</li> <li>3. Mohamed E.H. <i>How to Write a Research Proposal and Thesis</i>. Createspace Independent Pub, 2013</li> <li>4. Tshabangu, I., Ba, S., Madondo, S.M. <i>Research report writing: proposals, dissertations, and academic writing</i>. Book chapter in Research Anthology on Doctoral Student Professional Development, IGI Global, 2022</li> <li>5. Andrews, G. <i>Research proposal: Academic writing guide for graduate students</i>. 2017.</li> <li>6. Academic coaching: <a href="https://www.writeyourthesis.com/p/home.html">https://www.writeyourthesis.com/p/home.html</a></li> </ol> |
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